# TalentXO  Leads Management Module

**Product Requirements Document (PRD)**

| | |
|---|---|
| **Version** | V1.7 Final Consolidated |
| **Product** | TalentXO Recruitment Marketplace |
| **Release** | V1 / MVP |
| **Prepared for** | Product Analyst Assignment |
| **Primary Users** | Talent Partners (TPs) |
| **Supporting Users** | TalentXO Operations |
| **Document Status** | Final Assignment Proposal |

## Product Overview

### Business Context

TalentXO operates a recruitment marketplace connecting hiring companies with independent freelance recruiters known as Talent Partners (TPs).

Alongside candidates independently sourced by TPs, TalentXO maintains an existing candidate database.

A **lead** represents a candidate who is potentially relevant to a specific job but has not yet become an application for that job.

Making these leads available across multiple recruiters creates several operational challenges:

- Overlapping recruiter outreach for the same candidate and job.
- Relevant candidate opportunities remaining untouched.
- TPs claiming leads without making meaningful progress.
- Limited visibility into current progress and required next actions.
- Incomplete, outdated or inconsistent candidate information.
- Candidate eligibility or job requirements changing during recruitment.
- Duplicate applications or uncertain outcomes across recruitment channels.

### Product Objective

Design a centralized Leads Management Module that enables Talent Partners to:

1. Discover relevant candidate opportunities across different jobs.
2. Claim exclusive responsibility for individual candidate-job leads.
3. Contact candidates and record recruitment progress.
4. Identify pending actions, follow-ups and blockers.
5. Verify candidate suitability and job-specific authorization.

6. Convert qualified opportunities into valid applications.
7. Record unsuccessful outcomes and preserve recruitment history.

TalentXO Operations must have visibility into TP-level activities, candidate-job progress, inactive opportunities, ownership conflicts and final outcomes.

**Primary business objective:** Improve candidate-database utilization and valid lead-to-application conversion while reducing duplicate recruiter effort and abandoned opportunities.

### Fundamental Product Principles

- One candidate can have multiple job-specific opportunities.
- Only one TP can actively own a particular candidate-job opportunity.
- Outreach activity and confirmed recruitment progress are distinct.
- Every open lead must have a clear current state and next action.
- Candidate authorization is mandatory before submission.
- Historical progress must survive ownership changes.
- Material changes must trigger appropriate revalidation.
- Recruitment outcomes must remain traceable.

### V1 Scope Boundary

The lead lifecycle begins when a candidate is identified as potentially suitable for an active job and ends when the opportunity is submitted or closed.

Post-submission screening, interviews, offers and joining are managed by TalentXO's existing application process.

A Submitted lead will display the current downstream application stage through a read-only link, without introducing a complete Applicant Tracking System into V1.

## 1. Proposed End-to-End User Journey and Workflow Diagrams

### 1.1 User Roles and Responsibilities

| User | Responsibility |
|---|---|
| **Talent Partner** | Discover, claim, contact, qualify, follow up, verify, submit and close leads |
| **TalentXO Operations** | Monitor utilization, review exceptions, verify material changes, approve recovery and resolve sourcing disputes |
| **Candidate** | Confirm interest, provide updated information, authorize submission and communicate contact preferences |
| **System** | Enforce ownership, eligibility, claim limits, deadlines, permissions and submission validation |

Dedicated employer dashboards and full candidate accounts are not required for V1.

A limited candidate confirmation interaction is required for application authorization.

### 1.2 Seven-Phase Business Lifecycle

| Phase | Business process | Expected outcome |
|---|---|---|
| **1. Identify & Qualify** | Match candidates against open job requirements | Eligible candidate-job opportunities identified |
| **2. Distribute & Discover** | Make relevant leads visible under suitable jobs | TPs discover opportunities |
| **3. Claim & Coordinate** | Assign temporary exclusive ownership | One accountable TP per lead |
| **4. Engage Candidate** | Contact candidate and record responses | Candidate engagement and interest established |
| **5. Monitor & Recover** | Manage deadlines, follow-ups and stalled leads | Opportunities remain actionable |
| **6. Verify & Submit** | Validate eligibility, information, consent and duplicate checks | Valid application created |
| **7. Record Outcome** | Record submission or closure and maintain linked outcomes | Traceable recruitment history |

These are stages of one recruitment process, not separate systems.

### 1.3 Primary Talent Partner Journey

**Step 1 Discover**

The TP opens Available Leads and selects an active job.

The system displays relevant candidates based on defined job requirements and available candidate information.

**Step 2  Review**

The TP reviews candidate qualifications, experience, location, profile freshness and job suitability indicators.

Sensitive contact information remains restricted until authorized access is established.

**Step 3 Claim**

The TP selects Claim.

The system checks:

- Job is active.
- Candidate-job opportunity remains eligible.

- No other TP currently owns the lead.
- No known application already exists.
- Candidate contact is permitted.
- TP has available claim capacity.

If all checks pass, exclusive ownership is assigned.

**Step 4  Contact**

The TP contacts the candidate and records the communication outcome.

An unanswered call is recorded as an attempt, not successful contact.

**Step 5  Manage Progress**

The system records candidate responses, next actions, follow-up commitments and deadlines.

The TP can progress the lead, schedule follow-ups, release ownership or close it with a reason.

**Step 6  Verify**

For an interested candidate, the TP validates:

- Current job eligibility.
- Mandatory candidate information.
- Candidate interest for the specific job.
- Updated profile details.
- Known existing applications.

**Step 7 Obtain Authorization**

The candidate receives a job-specific confirmation request naming the employer and role.

Submission remains blocked until valid authorization is received.

**Step 8  Submit**

The system performs final validation and creates one application.

If submission is successful, the lead becomes Submitted.

If submission fails or its result is uncertain, the system retains the last valid state and verifies the outcome before allowing a safe retry.

**Step 9  Record Outcome**

The lead either:

- Becomes Submitted and links to the Application ID.
- Becomes Closed with a documented reason.
- Remains open for a valid follow-up.
- Enters controlled recovery or review when circumstances require it.

### 1.4 Candidate-Job Opportunity Relationship

**Example: Raghul  Candidate ID C-1025**

| Job | Lead ID | Eligibility | Assigned TP | Progress |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Python Developer | L-301 | Eligible | TP-101 | Contacted |
| Backend Developer | L-302 | Eligible | TP-205 | Interested |
| ML Engineer | — | Ineligible | — | Not offered |

Raghul has one candidate identity but two separately managed recruitment opportunities.

Each opportunity maintains its own owner, status, activity history and outcome.

A different TP may work on another job for Raghul, provided candidate-wide contact preferences are respected.

### 1.5 Decision-Based Workflow Diagrams

Three diagrams accompany this PRD.

**Diagram A  Lead-to-Application Lifecycle**

Demonstrates discovery, claiming, outreach, candidate interest, verification, authorization, submission and unsuccessful outcomes.

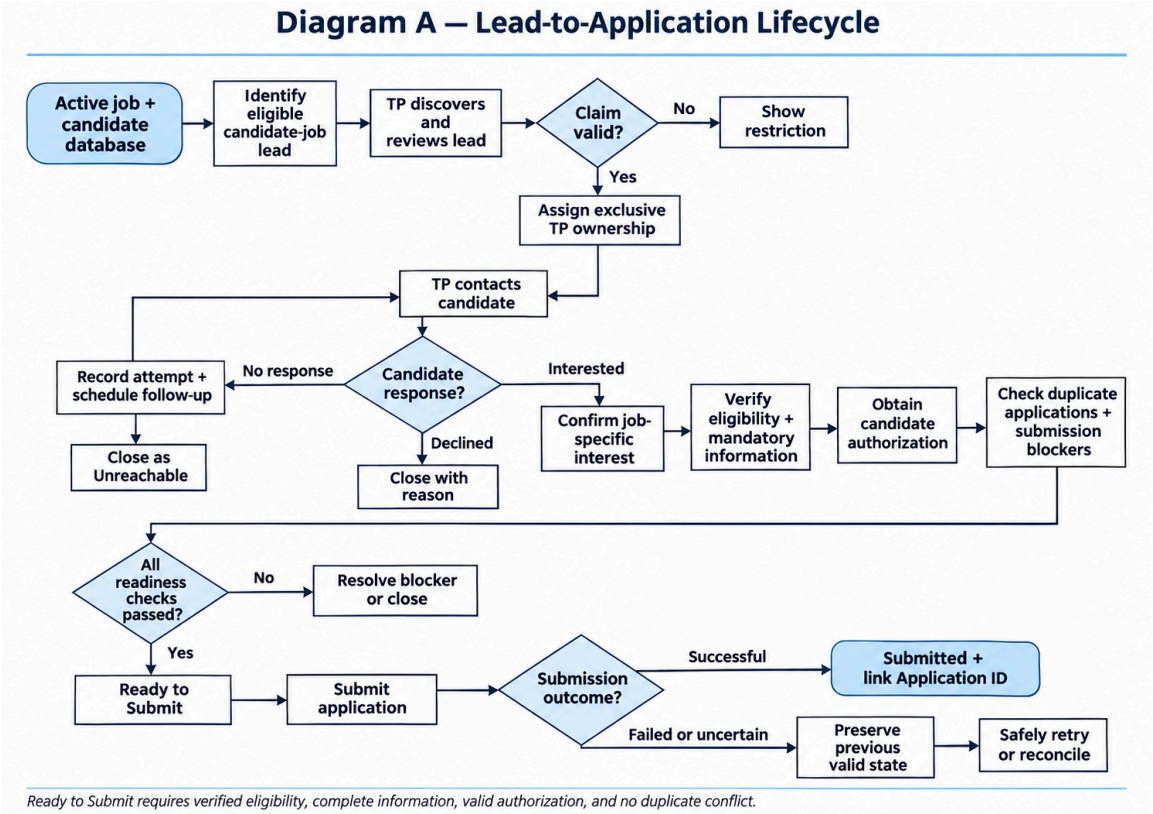


**Diagram B Ownership and Recovery**

Demonstrates claim capacity, ownership deadlines, inactivity, extensions, release, reassignment and engaged-lead protection.

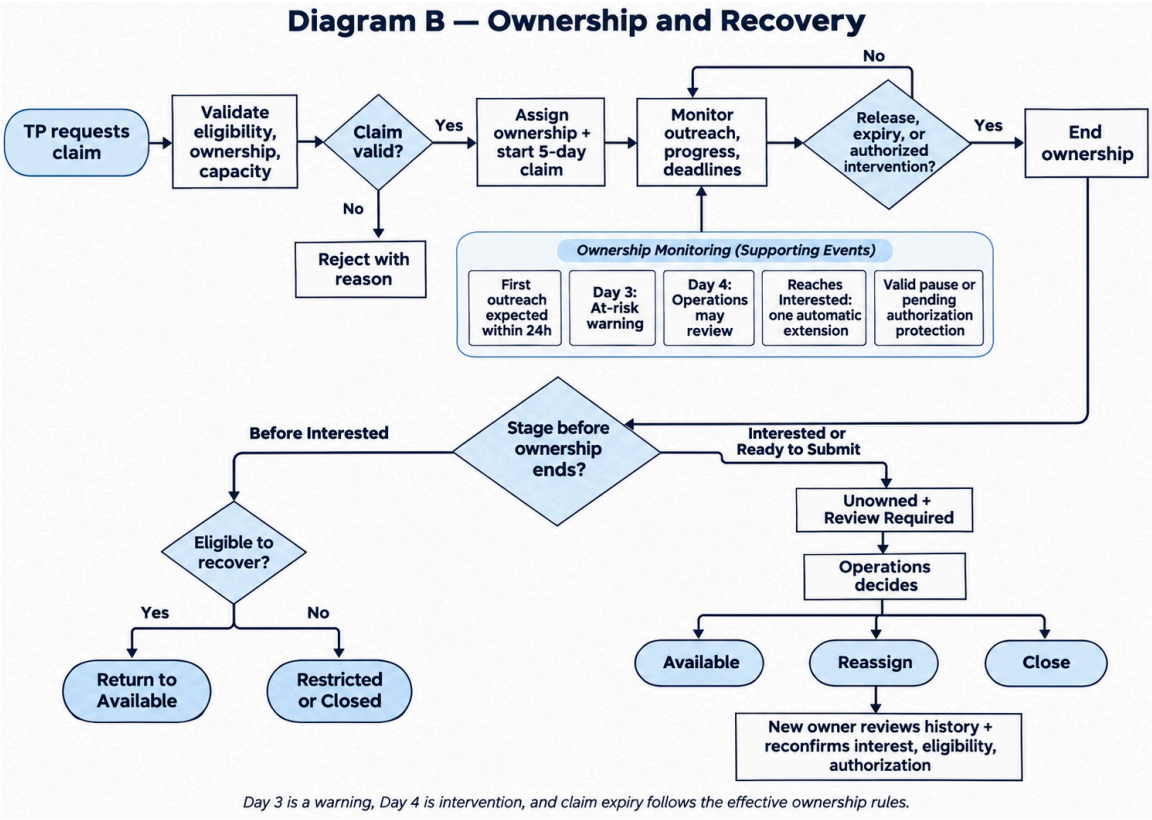
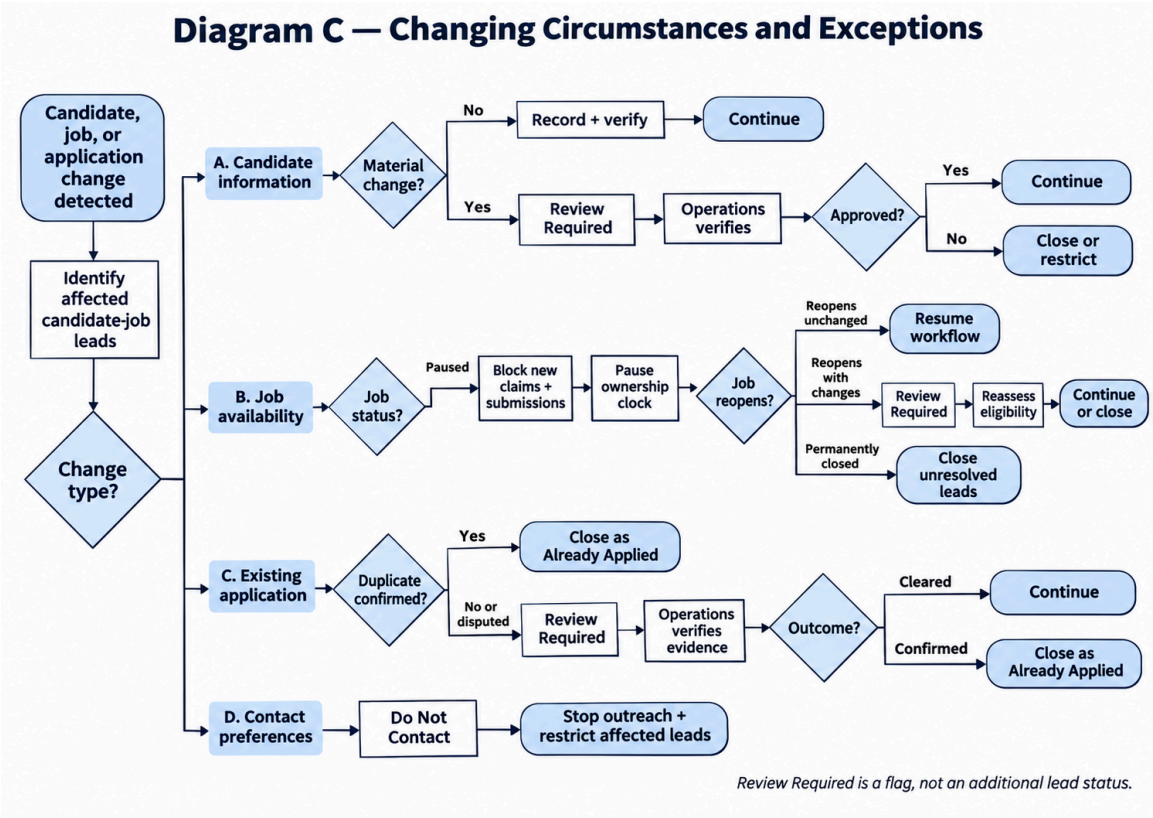



**Diagram C  Changing Circumstances and Exceptions**

Demonstrates data changes, job pause/reopen, application conflicts, material revalidation and contact restrictions.




All decisions in these diagrams must match the status-transition rules and exception handling in this PRD.

## 2. Key Product Screens, Actions and Status Transitions

### 2.1 Core Data Requirements

| Entity | Essential information |
|---|---|
| **Candidate** | Candidate ID, name, skills, experience, location, availability, contact preferences, verification history |
| **Job** | Job ID, company, role, mandatory criteria, hiring status, requirement version |
| **Talent Partner** | TP ID, name, permissions, active claim count |
| **Lead Opportunity** | Lead ID, Candidate ID, Job ID, current status, owner, next action, review flag, outcome |
| **Claim** | Owner, claim start, expiry, paused duration, extensions and historical owners |
| **Activity** | Activity type, result, timestamp, actor, communication method and source |

| Entity | Essential information |
|---|---|
| **Follow-up** | Next action, due date, responsible TP and completion |
| **Candidate Verification** | Field, reported value, master value, source, last-verified date and reviewer |
| **Authorization** | Candidate, company, job, request time, expiry, status and confirmation |
| **Application** | Application ID, linked lead, submitting TP, submission time and downstream stage |
| **Operations Review** | Review type, evidence, reviewer, decision, timestamps and resolution |

**Historical Data Preservation**

The platform must maintain:

1. Current lead status.
2. Previous highest recruitment stage achieved.
3. Last activity.
4. Last meaningful progress.
5. Last candidate engagement.
6. Next scheduled action.
7. Current owner and previous ownership history.

Historical records are not deleted when a lead is released, reassigned, submitted or closed.

## 2.2 Four Primary Product Screens

**Screen 1  Available Leads**

**Purpose:** Enable TPs to discover and claim job-relevant candidates.

**Displayed information**

- Active jobs and job requirements.
- Candidate ID and permitted candidate summary.
- Skills, experience and location.
- Job suitability indicators.
- Profile freshness.
- Lead availability.

**Actions**

- Select job.
- Search candidates.
- Filter leads.
- Review permitted details.

- Claim opportunity.

**System behavior**

- Existing ownership prevents another claim.
- A closed or paused job cannot receive new claims.
- Known existing applications block duplicate opportunity claims.
- Candidate-wide contact restrictions prevent prohibited outreach.
- Claim capacity must be available.

**Failure states:** Already Claimed, Claim Limit Reached, Job Unavailable, Existing Application and Contact Restricted.

**Screen 2 My Leads**

**Purpose:** Help TPs manage active opportunities across jobs.

**Displayed information**

- Candidate and job.
- Current status.
- Claim expiry or paused-clock indicator.
- Last activity.
- Last meaningful progress.
- Last candidate engagement.
- Next action and follow-up date.
- Verification and authorization blockers.

**Attention indicators**

- First outreach required.
- Follow-up overdue.
- No meaningful progress.
- Claim approaching expiry.
- Candidate information stale.
- Awaiting candidate confirmation.
- Confirmation expired — resend if permitted.
- Ready to Submit.
- Review Required.

**Actions**

- Filter by job, progress or urgency.
- Open a lead.
- Complete next action.
- Request permitted extension.
- Release ownership.

Reminder edits must not reset meaningful-progress or inactivity calculations.

**Screen 3  Lead Details**

**Purpose:** Manage the complete candidate-job recruitment workflow.

**Displayed information**

- Candidate and job requirements.
- Current ownership and expiry.
- Candidate contact history.
- Activity timeline.
- Previous highest stage.
- Reported and verified candidate information.
- Next required action.
- Authorization condition.
- Review restrictions.
- Linked application outcome if submitted.

**Actions**

- Access permitted contact information.
- Record communication attempt.
- Record candidate response.
- Update recruitment progress.
- Schedule follow-up.
- Report data correction.
- Request candidate confirmation.
- Release or close lead.
- Complete application verification and submission.

Verification and submission can appear as a panel or section within Lead Details, rather than an additional primary screen.

**Screen 4 TalentXO Operations Dashboard**

**Purpose:** Provide operational visibility and intervention capabilities.

**Displayed information**

- Available, claimed, aging, submitted and closed leads.
- TP name and unique TP ID.
- Candidate ID and associated job opportunities.
- Current and previous owners.
- Contact attempts and successful responses.
- Time to first outreach.
- Time to first successful contact.
- Stage durations and overdue follow-ups.
- Review Required and sourcing conflict cases.
- Application outcomes and closure reasons.

**Actions**

- Search by Candidate ID, Job ID or TP ID.
- Inspect recruiter activity and ownership.
- Review inactive or stalled leads.
- Approve material data corrections.
- Resolve ownership recovery and sourcing disputes.
- Reassign eligible opportunities.
- Review application conversion and outcomes.

Operations permissions are role-based.

Automated recruiter scoring or performance ranking is not included in V1.

## 2.3 Lead Status Model

The system uses seven primary display statuses.

| Status | Definition |
|---|---|
| **Available** | Eligible opportunity without an active owner |
| **Claimed** | TP owns the lead; successful contact not yet established |
| **Contacted** | Two-way communication with candidate established |
| **Interested** | Candidate confirms interest in the specific job |
| **Ready to Submit** | Eligibility, mandatory information, authorization and duplicate checks have passed |
| **Submitted** | Application successfully created and linked |
| **Closed** | Opportunity ended without submission, with a recorded reason |

**Closed reasons**

Not Interested, Unreachable, Not Qualified, Candidate Withdrawn, Do Not Contact, Job Closed and Already Applied.

**Separate Conditions**

- **Ownership:** Current owner, claim availability and historical owners.
- **Review:** Clear or Review Required.
- **Authorization:** Not Requested, Pending, Confirmed, Expired, Declined or Cancelled.
- **Attention:** Derived from activity, deadlines, pending actions and blockers.

These are not additional lead statuses.

### 2.4 Complete State-Transition Matrix

| Current condition | Event | Result | Validation |
|---|---|---|---|
| Available | Claim requested | Claimed | Job active, eligible, contact permitted, no owner, no known application, capacity available |
| Claimed | Contact attempt unanswered | Remains Claimed | Record activity and next action |
| Claimed | Two-way contact established | Contacted | Candidate response confirmed |
| Contacted | Candidate confirms interest | Interested | Job-specific interest recorded |
| Interested | Authorization requested | Remains Interested; authorization Pending | Valid owner; request limit available |
| Interested | Authorization expires | Remains Interested; authorization Expired | Resume ownership clock |
| Interested | Candidate declines authorization | Closed: Not Interested | Record decline |
| Interested | Candidate confirms authorization | Remains Interested; authorization Confirmed | Claim active; correct job and company |
| Interested | Verification completed | Ready to Submit | All four readiness conditions pass |
| Ready to Submit | Application successfully recorded | Submitted | Final ownership, eligibility, authorization and duplicate checks pass |
| Ready to Submit | Submission fails | Remains Ready to Submit if checks remain valid | Preserve last valid state and allow safe retry |
| Any open state | Submission result uncertain | Retain last valid state | Reconcile application result before retry |
| Claimed / Contacted | Release or expiry | Available if eligible | Automatic recovery checks; preserve history |
| Interested / Ready to Submit | Release or expiry | Unowned + Review Required | Operations ownership-recovery decision |

| Current condition | Event | Result | Validation |
|---|---|---|---|
| Any affected open lead | Material change | Review Required flag | Restrict affected actions |
| Review Required | Operations approves | Resume, Available or reassigned | Authorized recorded decision |
| Review Required | Operations rejects | Closed or remains restricted | Reason required |
| Any open state | Existing application confirmed | Closed: Already Applied | Notify affected TP |
| Any open state | Job permanently closes | Closed: Job Closed | Block further submission |
| Any open state | Candidate declines or withdraws | Closed | Document appropriate reason |
| Incorrectly Closed / Submitted | Authorized correction | Corrected valid state | Preserve original audit history |

**Application Readiness Rules**

A lead may move from **Interested to Ready to Submit only when all four conditions pass**:

1. Current job eligibility is verified.
2. Mandatory candidate information is complete and verified.
3. Job-specific candidate authorization is valid.
4. No known duplicate application or unresolved application conflict exists.

A failed or uncertain submission must never automatically create a Submitted state.

For uncertain results, the system first checks whether an application was actually created. A retry is permitted only when it cannot create a duplicate.

**Release and Reassignment Rules**

- Current ownership ends on a valid release or expiry.
- All prior activities and the previous highest stage remain intact.
- A new TP must reconfirm candidate interest and eligibility.
- A new TP must obtain fresh job-specific authorization before submission.
- Former owners lose owner-only action permissions.
- Unowned engaged leads require Operations review before becoming claimable again.

## 3. Business Problems Identified and Product Rules Derived

### BP-01 Relevant Lead Discovery and Distribution

**Problem**

TalentXO needs to connect existing candidate profiles with TPs working on relevant open jobs.

**Proposed solution**

Job-based lead discovery using candidate information and mandatory requirements.

**Product rules**

- Candidate, Job, Lead and TP IDs are unique.
- One canonical opportunity exists per candidate-job combination.
- Different jobs may have separate opportunities for the same candidate.
- Ineligible candidates are not offered for claiming.
- Rule-based matching is sufficient for V1.

**Expected business impact:** Better database utilization, faster lead discovery and reduced manual search effort.

### BP-02 Supporting TPs Toward Applications

**Problem**

Access to candidates does not ensure application conversion.

**Proposed solution**

Guided progression through outreach, interest confirmation, qualification, authorization and submission.

**Product rules**

- Unanswered outreach results in a follow-up action.
- Successful contact must be documented.
- Candidate interest is job-specific.
- Mandatory requirements are checked before submission.
- Candidate authorization cannot be self-certified by the TP.
- Final submission requires all readiness checks.

**Expected business impact:** Higher valid application conversion and fewer incomplete submissions.

### BP-03 Visibility and Next-Action Identification

**Problem**

TPs managing multiple opportunities may struggle to prioritize daily recruitment work.

**Proposed solution**

My Leads displays status, recent activity, next action, follow-up due date and restrictions.

**Product rules**

- Every actionable lead displays its next required action.
- Overdue follow-ups are highlighted.
- Inactivity and expiring ownership are visible.
- Authorization and review conditions are shown separately from status.
- Completed or closed leads do not receive ordinary follow-up reminders.

**Expected business impact:** Improved productivity and fewer forgotten opportunities.

## BP-04 Reliable Progress Tracking and Outcomes

**Problem**

Recruitment records and candidate information may become incomplete, outdated or inconsistent.

**Proposed solution**

Structured event histories, candidate-data freshness indicators, controlled corrections and linked application outcomes.

**Activity Tracking**

Record the type, result, timestamp and actor for meaningful actions.

Track independently:

- Last activity.
- Last meaningful progress.
- Last candidate engagement.
- Next scheduled action.

Repeated unanswered calls demonstrate effort but do not establish candidate progression.

Editing administrative notes or reminders cannot reset inactivity calculations.

**Candidate-Data Freshness**

- Relevant candidate fields retain their last-verified date.
- Information not verified within 90 days is flagged Stale.
- Mandatory stale fields must be reverified before Ready to Submit.
- TP-reported values remain distinguishable from verified master values.
- Reported values include source and timestamp.
- Material shared-data changes require Operations verification.

**Application Outcome Visibility**

A Submitted lead retains a read-only link to its application.

The latest known application stage is displayed from the existing application process.

Operations can view Submitted leads grouped by downstream stage and Closed leads grouped by closure reason.

**Expected business impact:** Better data reliability, accountability and outcome visibility.

## BP-05 Preventing Overlapping Recruitment Efforts

### Problem

Multiple TPs may approach the same candidate for the same job or attempt competing submissions.

### Proposed solution

Exclusive lead ownership and controlled sourcing conflict resolution.

### Ownership Rules

- Only one active TP owns a candidate-job lead.
- Simultaneous claims allow only one successful owner.
- Different jobs may have different owners for the same candidate.
- Unrelated TPs see restricted unavailable indicators.
- Recent cross-job outreach generates a coordination warning.
- Candidate-wide Do Not Contact restrictions override ownership.

### TP-Sourced Candidate Conflict

If a TP independently sources a candidate for a job whose lead is already claimed by another TP:

1. The system identifies the existing candidate-job opportunity.
2. No second application is created.
3. The competing submission receives the condition Pending Conflict Review.
4. The affected claim clock pauses during review.
5. Operations targets a decision within two business days.
6. Overdue reviews are escalated, not automatically awarded to either TP.

**Decision criteria, applied in order:**

1. Whom the candidate's job-specific confirmation explicitly authorizes or names.
2. Documented candidate engagement preceding the competing submission.
3. Relevant claim and submission timestamps where earlier evidence is inconclusive.

Operations records the attribution decision and supporting evidence.

The authorized submission proceeds. Competing submissions are rejected, and any redundant opportunity is closed with a reason.

Only one valid application is ultimately recorded.

**Expected business impact:** Reduced duplicate outreach, more reliable attribution and better candidate experience.

## BP-06 Preventing Unutilized and Stalled Opportunities

### Problem

Leads may remain untouched, or TPs may claim opportunities without meaningful progress.

**Proposed solution**

Lead-aging monitoring, claim limits, time-bound ownership, contextual warnings and controlled recovery.

**Ownership Policy**

| Event | Proposed rule |
|---|---|
| **Claim created** | Five-calendar-day ownership starts |
| **Claim capacity** | Maximum 10 active claims per TP |
| **First outreach** | Expected within 24 hours |
| **No meaningful progress by Day 3** | At-risk warning |
| **Day 4 without justified progress** | Operations may review or intervene |
| **Standard expiry** | Day 5 unless valid extension or pause applies |
| **First reaching Interested** | One automatic extension |
| **Extension expiry** | Later of existing expiry or five days from first Interested |
| **Reaching Ready to Submit** | No additional automatic extension |
| **Exceptional extension** | Requires Operations approval |

**Inactivity Versus Expiry**

**Day 3 is a warning, not expiry.**

The At Risk indicator highlights stalled progress but does not automatically remove ownership.

**Day 4 allows intervention, not automatic release.**

Operations may review genuinely abandoned opportunities or initiate an authorized action.

Ownership ends only after a valid release, applicable expiry or authorized intervention, considering existing protections.

**Meaningful Progress**

Meaningful progress includes:

- Confirmed two-way engagement.
- Candidate interest confirmed.
- Qualification completed.
- Required verification completed.
- Valid submission or justified closure.

Unanswered calls and reminder edits do not independently extend ownership.

**Unreachable Policy**

Three unsuccessful attempts across at least three days trigger an Unreachable review.

After reviewing the activity history and valid candidate commitments, the TP may close the lead as Unreachable.

Operations may reopen it if new verified contact information makes further outreach appropriate.

**Candidate Confirmation and Ownership Clock**

| Policy | Proposed rule |
|---|---|
| **Confirmation request validity** | 48 hours |
| **Maximum requests** | Two per claim |
| **Maximum cumulative clock pause** | 48 hours |
| **Clock resumes** | On confirmation, decline, expiry or exhaustion of pause allowance |
| **Candidate confirms near expiry** | Ensure 24 hours remain if the claim is active |
| **Claim already expired** | Cancel confirmation; do not restore ownership |

**24-hour completion safeguard**

When a candidate confirms authorization, if the claim is still active and less than 24 hours remain, the expiry is set to 24 hours from confirmation.

This is a submission-completion safeguard, not another automatic extension triggered by recruitment progress.

If the claim expired before confirmation, the request is cancelled.

**Controlled Release and Recovery**

**Before Interested**

A Claimed or Contacted lead released or expired undergoes automatic recovery checks.

If job eligibility and contact permissions remain valid, it returns to Available.

**At Interested or Ready to Submit**

Ownership ends.

The lead becomes unowned with Review Required — Ownership Recovery.

Other TPs see Unavailable.

Operations decides whether to:

- Return the opportunity to Available.

- Reassign it to a named TP.
- Close it with a documented reason.

**Target resolution:** Two business days.

Pending authorization is cancelled on any release or expiry, and the former TP's claim slot is freed immediately.

**Expected business impact:** Better lead utilization without penalizing legitimate recruitment progress.

### BP-07 — Handling Changing Candidate and Job Circumstances

**Problem**

Candidate details, job requirements, hiring availability and application records may change throughout recruitment.

**Proposed solution**

Change Detection → Impact Assessment → Revalidation → Resolution.

**Material Candidate or Job Qualification Changes**

1. Identify affected candidate-job leads.
2. Set Review Required with the reason.
3. Block affected submissions or progression.
4. Notify the TP and Operations.
5. Require Operations verification of relevant information.
6. If approved, clear the restriction and continue from the last valid state.
7. If rejected, close the opportunity or retain the appropriate restriction.

Routine non-material corrections can follow a simpler verified-update path.

**Job Pause and Reopen**

**Job paused**

- Stop new claims and submissions.
- Pause ownership clocks.
- Existing owners retain their claims.
- Paused claims continue counting toward the TP cap.
- After 14 days, affected claims enter Operations review for a keep/release decision.

**Job reopened**

- Resume ownership clocks with remaining time.
- Revalidation is required only if relevant requirements or eligibility changed.
- Otherwise, resume the prior valid workflow.

**Job closed**

- Prevent new claims and submissions.

- Close affected unresolved opportunities.
- Preserve ownership and activity history.

**Existing Applications and External Channels**

Known existing applications are checked:

- Before claiming.
- At significant progression/readiness checks.
- Through available record reconciliation.
- Immediately before final submission.

A TP or candidate may report an application through another channel.

**Confirmed duplicate:** Block submission and close as Already Applied.

**Disputed or unverified duplicate:** Set Review Required, preserve existing ownership/history and block conflicting submission.

Operations reviews application records, candidate confirmation and supporting evidence before deciding.

An unverified external-application report must never automatically close the lead.

**Candidate Withdrawal and Do Not Contact**

Candidate withdrawal of application authorization blocks submission.

A candidate-wide Do Not Contact instruction stops prohibited outreach, suppresses affected opportunities and invalidates associated authorizations where applicable.

**Expected business impact:** Fewer invalid submissions, less wasted effort and reliable handling of changing circumstances.

## 4. Important Edge Cases and Expected System Behavior

### 4.1 Edge-Case Matrix

| Scenario | Expected system behavior |
|---|---|
| **Two TPs claim the same lead simultaneously** | First valid claim succeeds; competing claim rejected |
| **Candidate eligible for multiple jobs** | Independent job-specific opportunities |
| **TP reaches claim cap** | New claim blocked |
| **No outreach within 24 hours** | Reminder and attention indicator |
| **Three days without meaningful progress** | At Risk warning, not expiry |
| **Day-four inactivity** | Operations may review or intervene |

| Scenario | Expected system behavior |
|---|---|
| **Three unanswered calls across three days** | Record effort and trigger Unreachable review |
| **Candidate requests later contact** | Preserve agreed follow-up and apply valid extension policy |
| **Candidate information outdated** | Mark Stale; mandatory fields must be verified |
| **Material qualification change** | Review Required; Operations verification |
| **Interested reached near expiry** | One qualifying automatic extension |
| **Ready to Submit reached later** | No second progress extension |
| **Confirmation expires** | Resume clock; remain Interested |
| **Candidate declines authorization** | Close as Not Interested |
| **Candidate confirms near expiry** | Provide 24-hour minimum remaining ownership |
| **Claim expired before confirmation** | Cancel confirmation |
| **Claimed/Contacted lead released** | Eligibility check before making Available |
| **Interested/Ready lead released** | Unowned + Review Required; Operations decision |
| **New TP receives reassigned lead** | Reconfirm interest, eligibility and authorization |
| **Job temporarily pauses** | Stop claims/submissions and pause clock |
| **Job reopens unchanged** | Resume clock without mandatory review |
| **Job reopens after material changes** | Revalidate affected leads |
| **Confirmed existing application** | Close as Already Applied |
| **Disputed application** | Block conflicting submission; review evidence |
| **TP-sourced submission conflicts with owned lead** | Hold competing submission; no second application |
| **Candidate requests Do Not Contact** | Stop prohibited outreach |
| **Submission fails** | Preserve last valid state and allow safe retry |
| **Submission result uncertain** | Reconcile before any retry; do not assume Submitted |
| **Wrongly closed/submitted lead** | Operations correction with audit history |
| **Submitted application advances** | Reflect downstream stage read-only |

### 4.2 Notification Requirements

| Event | Recipient | Information |
|---|---|---|
| **Successful claim** | TP | Claim confirmation and expiry |
| **Initial outreach overdue** | TP | Required next action |
| **Follow-up due** | TP | Candidate, job and due date |
| **Lead at risk** | TP | Warning reason and remaining time |
| **Claim extension** | TP | Revised expiry |
| **Confirmation requested** | TP | Pending condition and expiry |
| **Confirmation expires** | TP | Available next action |
| **Candidate confirms** | TP | Authorization confirmed |
| **Ownership expires** | Former TP | Ownership ended |
| **Engaged-lead recovery** | Operations | Lead and required decision |
| **Material qualification change** | TP and Operations | Review reason and restriction |
| **Duplicate application dispute** | Operations | Evidence review required |
| **TP-sourced conflict** | Affected TPs and Operations | Pending conflict review |
| **Job paused/reopened** | Affected TPs | Job status and timing effect |
| **Submission succeeds/fails** | TP | Result and next action |
| **Linked application stage changes** | Authorized users | Updated downstream outcome |

### 4.3 Permissions

| Action | Current TP owner | Other TP | Authorized Operations |
|---|---|---|---|
| **View eligible lead summary** | Yes | Yes | Yes |
| **Claim available lead** | If eligible | If eligible | Authorized intervention |
| **View private candidate details** | Permitted | No | Role-based |
| **Record outreach** | Yes | No | Audited correction |
| **Update progress** | Yes | No | Authorized correction |

| Action | Current TP owner | Other TP | Authorized Operations |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Schedule follow-up** | Yes | No | Oversight |
| **Request authorization** | Within limits | No | Authorized support |
| **Submit application** | After validation | No | Authorized oversight |
| **Release owned lead** | Yes | No | Yes |
| **Approve material corrections** | No | No | Yes |
| **Reassign engaged lead** | Request | No | Yes |
| **Resolve TP-sourced conflict** | No | No | Yes |
| **Correct terminal outcome** | No | No | Yes, audited |
| **View all TP performance** | No | No | Role-based |

Owner-only permissions are rechecked when an action is committed.

### 4.4 Failure Handling

Every failed operation must:

1. Explain the blocking reason.
2. Preserve the last valid state.
3. Avoid duplicate claims or applications.
4. Display the next permitted action.
5. Record relevant failures for investigation.

**Examples**

- Lead already claimed → Display Unavailable.
- Claim limit reached → Explain capacity limit.
- Stale mandatory information → Identify fields requiring verification.
- Candidate authorization pending → Disable submission.
- Disputed duplicate → Review Required; block conflicting action.
- Ownership expired → Reject former owner's updates.
- Uncertain submission → Reconcile existing application before retry.
- Job closed → Block submission and record closure.

## 5. Key Assumptions and Design Decisions

### 5.1 Major Product Decisions

| Decision | Rationale |
|---|---|
| **Seven primary lead statuses** | Clear, manageable progression |

| Decision | Rationale |
|---|---|
| **Separate candidate and job-specific lead identity** | Supports multiple legitimate opportunities |
| **Exclusive TP ownership** | Prevents overlapping recruitment |
| **Separate activities and statuses** | Distinguishes effort from real progress |
| **Preserve highest historical stage** | Maintains context after reassignment |
| **New-owner revalidation** | Prevents outdated interest/authorization reuse |
| **Time-limited claims** | Recovers inactive opportunities |
| **Contextual next actions** | Makes progress tracking useful |
| **Candidate job-specific confirmation** | Prevents self-certified submissions |
| **Review Required flag** | Handles exceptions without additional statuses |
| **Operations-reviewed conflict decisions** | Improves attribution transparency |
| **Candidate-data freshness** | Addresses outdated or incomplete records |
| **Read-only application outcome linkage** | Provides eventual outcome visibility without building an ATS |
| **TP-level monitoring** | Supports accountability and operational decisions |

### 5.2 Assumptions Requiring TalentXO Validation

| Proposed policy | Initial setting |
|---|---|
| **Active claim cap** | 10 per TP |
| **Initial claim duration** | 5 calendar days |
| **First outreach** | Within 24 hours |
| **Inactivity warning** | Day 3 |
| **Early intervention** | From Day 4 |
| **Automatic extension** | Once at Interested |
| **Extension calculation** | Later of current expiry or 5 days from Interested |
| **Authorization request validity** | 48 hours |
| **Authorization request limit** | 2 per claim |

| Proposed policy | Initial setting |
|---|---|
| **Cumulative authorization clock pause** | 48 hours |
| **Minimum remaining claim after authorization** | 24 hours |
| **Candidate-data stale threshold** | 90 days |
| **Unreachable review** | 3 attempts over at least 3 days |
| **Paused-job Operations review** | 14 days |
| **Ownership recovery target** | 2 business days |
| **TP-sourced conflict target** | 2 business days |

These are proposed operating values, not policies explicitly confirmed by TalentXO.

Additional assumptions concern matching criteria, recruiter permission levels, available application records and the implementation of candidate confirmation.

### 5.3 V1 Exclusions

The MVP does not include:

- AI-powered candidate ranking.
- Automated recruiter allocation.
- Automated TP performance scoring or ranking.
- Predictive hiring recommendations.
- Automated mass outreach.
- Recruiter payment or commission calculations.
- A complete applicant tracking system.

### 5.4 Key Product Trade-offs

**Exclusive ownership versus lead utilization:** Prevent duplication while allowing controlled release and reassignment.

**Activity monitoring versus recruiter effort:** Separate unsuccessful outreach from meaningful progress to avoid misleading performance interpretation.

**Verification versus submission speed:** Require essential checks without adding review to every routine update.

**Automation versus Operations workload:** Automate predictable recovery paths while keeping material disputes human-reviewed.

**Candidate privacy versus operational visibility:** Allow authorized oversight without exposing sensitive candidate information to unrelated recruiters.

## Success Metrics

### North Star  Validated Lead-to-Application Conversion Rate

Percentage of eligible candidate-job lead opportunities in a defined cohort that achieve a validated application submission within an agreed reporting window.

### Supporting Metrics

| Metric | Definition |
|---|---|
| **Time to first outreach** | Time from claim to first recorded contact attempt |
| **Claim-to-contact rate** | Percentage of claimed leads with confirmed two-way contact |
| **Interest-to-submission rate** | Percentage of interested leads resulting in a validated submission |
| **Expired-claim rate** | Percentage of claims ending through ownership expiry |
| **Follow-up completion rate** | Percentage of due follow-ups completed within the required window |

Metrics should use consistent cohorts, reporting windows and exclusions.

A submitted application is a conversion outcome, not automatically a successful hire.

## Prototype Requirements

The clickable prototype must demonstrate the primary TP journey and important exceptional scenarios.

### Sample Data

| Candidate | ID | Scenario |
|---|---|---|
| **Raghul** | C-1025 | Eligible for Python and Backend roles |
| **Priya** | C-1026 | Interested; authorization pending |
| **Arjun** | C-1027 | Repeated unsuccessful outreach |
| **Meera** | C-1028 | Existing application conflict |
| **Karthik** | C-1029 | Outdated mandatory candidate information |

### Main Demonstrations

1. Discover and claim an available candidate-job opportunity.
2. Contact a candidate and update progress.
3. Schedule and complete a follow-up.
4. Verify an interested candidate and request authorization.
5. Submit one valid application.

6. Demonstrate separate opportunities for the same candidate.
7. Demonstrate competing ownership or a blocked duplicate.
8. Demonstrate inactivity and controlled recovery.
9. Demonstrate material change and Operations revalidation.
10. Demonstrate Operations search by Candidate ID and TP ID.

Real production authentication, integrations and persistence are not necessary for the prototype.

## Product Acceptance Criteria

The proposed V1 is acceptable when:

1. TPs can discover eligible leads across different active jobs.
2. A candidate may have independent opportunities for multiple jobs.
3. Only one TP can actively own any given candidate-job lead.
4. Contact attempts and meaningful progress remain distinct.
5. My Leads makes next actions, follow-ups and deadlines visible.
6. Ownership warnings do not automatically cause premature expiry.
7. Claim extensions, pauses and recovery follow documented rules.
8. Historical recruitment progress survives release or reassignment.
9. Reassigned leads require fresh interest, eligibility and authorization checks.
10. Stale mandatory candidate information is flagged and reverified.
11. Candidate authorization is required before Ready to Submit.
12. Failed or uncertain submission never automatically becomes Submitted.
13. Confirmed duplicate applications are prevented.
14. Disputed duplicates require evidence-based Operations review.
15. Operations can monitor TP-level progress and resolve exceptions.
16. Submitted leads display linked downstream application outcomes.
17. Significant changes and decisions retain an audit history.
18. Automated TP performance ranking is excluded from V1.

## Conclusion

The TalentXO Leads Management Module transforms an existing candidate database into a coordinated, accountable recruitment opportunity pipeline.

The proposed V1 combines job-specific discovery, exclusive ownership, guided candidate engagement, reliable progress tracking, controlled recovery, candidate verification, duplicate prevention and operational oversight.

**Core product principle:** Every candidate-job opportunity must have a clear current condition, accountable ownership where applicable, a valid next action and a traceable outcome.